Ideation Phase

Project Title : Automating Data Import and Relationship Mapping using Import Sets and Dot Walking

1. Introduction

In modern organizations, handling large volumes of data efficiently is very important. In platforms like ServiceNow, data is often imported from external sources such as Excel or CSV files. However, performing this process manually can lead to errors, inconsistencies, and increased workload. This project focuses on automating data import and establishing relationships between tables using Import Sets and Dot Walking, which improves accuracy and reduces manual effort.

2. Problem Statement

In the current system, manual data import and relationship mapping in ServiceNow is inefficient, time-consuming, and prone to human errors. Users must manually map fields and maintain relationships between different tables, which increases complexity and chances of mistakes. Additionally, verifying and correcting errors takes extra time and effort.

Therefore, there is a need to design and develop an automated system using Import Sets and Dot Walking to simplify data import, ensure proper relationship mapping, reduce errors, and improve overall system efficiency.

3. Empathy Map

To understand the user's behavior, thoughts, feelings, and challenges:

- **Say:** Users often say that manual data upload takes too much time and that field mapping is confusing. They also mention that errors frequently occur during the import process.
- **Think:** From their perspective, they think there should be an easier and automated way to perform these tasks. They also worry about making mistakes, especially when dealing with large datasets.
- **Do:** In their daily activities, users manually upload files, create Transform Maps, and repeatedly check records to ensure correctness.

- **Feel:** This repetitive process makes them feel frustrated, stressed, and sometimes confused, especially when relationships between tables are not properly maintained.

4. Idea Listing and Grouping

Through brainstorming, the following ideas were generated and categorized to address the core problem:

- **Data Import Automation:** Using Import Sets for bulk data upload and scheduling automatic imports to reduce manual intervention.
- **Data Mapping:** Creating Transform Maps for mapping source and target tables and automating field mapping using scripts.
- **Relationship Handling:** Using Dot Walking to access related fields and automatically establish relationships between tables such as user and department.
- **Monitoring & Accuracy:** Implementing data validation techniques to ensure data accuracy before import, creating error handling mechanisms, and developing dashboards to monitor the import process.

5. Idea Prioritization

To ensure an efficient use of time and resources, the ideas were prioritized based on impact, feasibility, and required implementation time:

- **High Priority (Core Functionality):** Import Sets, Transform Maps, Dot Walking, and automatic relationship mapping. These are essential for solving the core problem and provide the maximum impact.
- **Medium Priority (System Enhancements):** Data validation, scheduled imports, and error handling mechanisms. These enhance reliability but are not part of the baseline core functionality.
- **Low Priority (Additional Benefits):** Dashboards and advanced monitoring features. While beneficial, they are not critical for the basic working of the system.